



HIMALAYAN WOMEN AWARENESS AND LIVELIHOOD SOCIETY (HIMWAL)

A New Milestone in Institutional Collaboration

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING SIGNED WITH CSIR-IHBT

HIMWAL Society is proud to announce the signing of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the **CSIR-Institute of Himalayan Bioresource Technology (CSIR-IHBT), Palampur (H.P.)**, marking a significant step forward in strengthening research-driven, community-focused development across the Himalayan region.

The MoU was formally signed on **28 May 2026**, on the occasion of the **National Technology Day Celebration & Inauguration of the BioValorization Research Block** at CSIR-IHBT, Palampur, in the gracious presence of dignitaries including **Dr. Jitendra Singh**, Hon'ble Union Minister of State (Independent Charge) for Science & Technology and Earth Sciences, and Vice-President, CSIR.



HIMWAL Society representatives at the National Technology Day Celebration, CSIR-IHBT Palampur, 28 May 2026

Partner One	Partner Two
CSIR-Institute of Himalayan Bioresource Technology (CSIR-IHBT) Post Bag No. 6, Palampur - 176 061 (H.P.), India A constituent institute of the Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR)	Himalayan Women, Awareness & Livelihood (HIMWAL) Society THDC Colony, Tea Estate, Banjarawala, Dehradun-248001, Uttarakhand, India

DATE OF SIGNING
28 May 2026

VALIDITY
5 Years

NATURE
R&D Collaboration

Purpose of the MoU

This MoU lays the foundation for research & development cooperation between the two institutions, enabling HIMWAL to draw upon CSIR-IHBT's scientific expertise, technologies, and knowledgebase for the benefit of farmer communities and grassroots livelihood initiatives in the Himalayan region.

Key Areas of Cooperation

- **Seabuckthorn, Medicinal & Aromatic Plants (MAPs) and Floriculture:** Joint R&D collaboration for cultivation, value addition, and utilization.
- **Millets, Food & Nutraceuticals:** Collaborative work on value-added products and nutrition-focused initiatives.
- **Capacity Building:** Research programs, technical services, and consultancy activities in mutually agreed areas.
- **Knowledge Exchange:** Sharing of academic and research material, and publications available in the public domain.
- **Planting Material Supply:** Access to quality planting material of MAPs for farmer groups and Self Help Groups (SHGs), on payment basis or free-of-cost under CSIR Mission projects, subject to availability.
- **Industry Linkages:** Establishing connections with the aroma and herbal industry to support commercialization.

A Shared Vision

Both institutions have jointly agreed that responsibilities, obligations, and any fees relating to specific technologies or services will be finalized separately in writing, with no financial liability arising from this MoU alone. The partners may also pursue joint projects with funding from national and international agencies in areas of shared interest — furthering HIMWAL's mission of sustainable livelihoods rooted in scientific collaboration.

This partnership reflects HIMWAL Society's continued commitment to bridging traditional Himalayan knowledge systems with modern scientific research, opening new opportunities for the communities it serves.

Signatories

For CSIR-IHBT	For HIMWAL Society
Dr. Sukhjinder Singh	Dr. Deepika Dimri
Principal Scientist & Coordinator, BDMU, CSIR-IHBT, Palampur - 176 061	Scientist & Secretary, HIMWAL Society, Dehradun-248001 (Uttarakhand)
Dr. Rakesh Kumar	Dr. Nand Kishore Hatwal
Chief Scientist, Agrotechnology Division, CSIR-IHBT, Palampur - 176 061 (Witness)	President, HIMWAL Society, Dehradun-248001 (Uttarakhand) (Witness)
Dr. Vidyshankar Srivastan	Ms. Shalini Singh
Principal Scientist, Dietetics and Nutrition Division, CSIR-IHBT, Palampur - 176 061	Coordinator, HIMWAL Society, Dehradun-248001 (Uttarakhand)
Dr. Ramesh	Mr. M.P. Dimri
Senior Scientist, Agrotechnology Division, CSIR-IHBT, Palampur - 176 061	Member, HIMWAL Society, Dehradun-248001 (Uttarakhand)

Contact Details

Lane no. 6 (E), THDC Colony, Tea Estate Banjarawala, Dehradun-248121
(Uttarakhand)

contact.himwal@gmail.com | +91-9027782863, +91-7454097237

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Society (HIMWAL)

Join us as a volunteer and share your suggestions via email (contact.himwal@gmail.com)